

Module 02: Agents — Family Members

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that every person is an **Agent**.
2. Learn that agents have **Goals** (Things they want to do).
3. Know that we all see the world differently (**Perspectives**).

Introduction: The Main Character

In a video game, you control the "Main Character." In real life, YOU are the main character of your story. But guess what? Mom is the main character of *her* story. Your brother is the main character of *his* story. We are all **Agents** sharing the same house!

Key Concepts

1. Goals (The "Why")

Why is Dad cleaning? (Goal: Clean House). Why is the Baby crying? (Goal: Milk). Everyone acts to reach their Goal. Sometimes goals clash!

- My Goal: Play loud music.
- Mom's Goal: Sleep.
- **Conflict!**

2. Agency (Superpower)

Agency is the power to make things happen.

- You can choose what to wear.
- You can choose how to play.
- You can choose to be kind. Babies have little agency. You have more. Parents have a lot.

3. Perspectives (The Goggles)

Imagine wearing colored glasses.

- To a Cat, the couch is a scratching post.
- To Mom, the couch is for sitting.
- To You, the couch is a fort. Same object, different meanings. Active Inference teaches us to respect how others see the world.

Activities

Activity 1: The "Why" Detective

Watch a family member do something. Guess their Goal. "Why is Mom putting on shoes?"

- Guess: She is going for a run.
- Ask: "Mom, what is your goal?"
- Answer: "To get the mail." Did you guess right?

Activity 2: Switch Shoes

Put on someone else's shoes (literally!). Walk around the house. Pretend to be them.

- If you are Dad, what do you check? (The thermostat? The locks?)
- If you are the Baby, what do you see? (Only knees and table legs!). How does the house feel different?

Summary

We are all Agents with our own goals and feelings. When we understand what other people want (their Goals) and what they see (their Perspective), we fight less and love more.

References

- *Don't Let the Pigeon Drive the Bus!* (About goals and wants)
- *They All Saw a Cat* by Brendan Wenzel